

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr B Wu

Address: 69 Holland Avenue Cheam SM2 6HT

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Statement to Planning Committee - Objection to Planning Application DM2025/01591

Chair, Members of the Committee,

Thank you for the opportunity to comment. I am addressing you today as a local resident to outline why this application, in its current form, would have a significant and harmful impact on our community. My concerns relate to noise, traffic, parking, safety, and the cumulative impact of the proposed use, Inaccurate Representation of Usage - all of which conflict with key policies in the Sutton Local Plan and the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF).

1. Noise and Late Evening Disturbance

The applicant suggests attendance of around 120 people, but in reality it is not practical to restrict numbers for Friday prayers. The Council must therefore consider the true maximum capacity of around 250 people, with activities running until 11pm.

This is a quiet residential area. The dispersal of up to 250 people at 11pm would cause unavoidable noise and disturbance.

Relevant policies:

- Sutton Local Plan Policy 29 (Amenity) - requires protection of residents from noise and disturbance.

- NPPF Paragraphs 130(f) and 185(a) - developments must safeguard residential amenity and be appropriate for their location.

2. Traffic and Highway Safety

The site sits within 100 meters from a primary school with over 1,000 pupils. At school drop off and pick up times, the roads are already heavily congested, with high pedestrian activity and limited visibility.

Adding up to 250 additional visitors - particularly during Friday prayers, which may overlap with school finishing times - would create serious safety risks for children and families.

Relevant policies:

- Policy 34 (Transport and Development) - development must not create or worsen highway hazards.
- NPPF Paragraph 111 - development should be refused if it results in an unacceptable impact on highway safety.

3. Parking Pressure

Parking in the area is already extremely limited. The application does not demonstrate how it will accommodate the parking needs of such a large number of visitors.

Over-spill parking would obstruct driveways, reduce visibility, and increase risks for pedestrians - particularly schoolchildren.

Relevant policies:

- Policy 37 (Parking) - requires adequate on site parking and avoidance of harmful over-spill.
- NPPF Paragraphs 105-106 - developments must consider local parking pressures and avoid adverse impacts.

4. Cumulative Impact on the Community

When noise, late night activity, school related congestion, parking pressure, and safety risks are considered together, the cumulative impact is substantial.

The scale and intensity of the proposed use are not compatible with the residential character of the area.

Relevant policies:

- Policy 1 (Sustainable Growth) - development must be appropriate to its context.
- Policy 28 (Character and Design) - requires development to respect the surrounding area.
- NPPF Paragraph 92 - planning should support safe, healthy, and inclusive communities.

5. Inaccurate Representation of Usage

The application suggests that the proposal is simply a relocation of existing activities from Belmont Church. However, this is misleading. Currently, the church is only utilized for Friday afternoon

prayers. Because the Islamic faith requires five daily prayers, seven days a week, the transition to a dedicated mosque will significantly increase the frequency and intensity of site usage compared to the current arrangement.

Conclusion

This application conflicts with multiple Local Plan and NPPF policies. It would introduce significant noise, traffic, parking stress, and safety risks - particularly given the proximity of a large primary school.

For these reasons, I respectfully ask the Committee to refuse this Planning Application DM2025/01591.

Thank you.